

Homework for Chap 8

With the effective mass approximation, do the following calculations:

1. Suppose the bandgap of GaAs at $T=300$ K is 1.42 eV and the electron effective mass is $0.062m_0$, calculate the density of states at energy of 1.52 eV and the effective density of states for nondegenerate electron gas in three dimensional (3D) GaAs.
2. For a GaAs quantum well with the well width of 3 nm, suppose the barrier height is infinite, calculate the first quantized energy E_1 for the 2-dimensional (2D) electrons and the corresponding electron density of states at this quantized energy E_1 .
3. Calculate the electron density of states for 3D electron gas at the energy E_1 , obtained in Q2, and compare the value with the density of states for 2D electrons at E_1 .

$$1. \quad g(E) = \frac{1}{2\pi^2} \left(\frac{2m^*}{\hbar^2} \right)^{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{E - E_c}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2\pi^2} \left(\frac{0.062m_0 \times 2}{\hbar^2} \right)^{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{E - E_c} = 2.08 \times 10^{44} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ J}^{-1} = 3.33 \times 10^{25} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ eV}^{-1}$$

If the spin is considered, $g(E) = 2 \times 3.3 \times 10^{25} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ eV}^{-1} = 6.6 \times 10^{25} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ eV}^{-1}$

Effective density states:

$$N_c = 2 \left(\frac{2\pi m^* k_B T}{h^2} \right)^{\frac{3}{2}} = 3.87 \times 10^{23} \text{ m}^{-3}$$

$$2. \quad E_1 = \frac{\hbar^2 \pi^2}{2m^* L^2} \Rightarrow E_1 = 1.080 \times 10^{-1} \text{ J} = 0.674 \text{ eV}$$

$$g_{2D} = \frac{m^*}{\pi \hbar^2} = 1.62 \times 10^{26} \text{ m}^{-2} \text{ J}^{-1}$$

$$= 2.6 \times 10^{17} \text{ m}^{-2} \text{ eV}^{-1}$$

If the spin is considered, $g_{2D} = 5.2 \times 10^{17} \text{ m}^{-2} \text{ eV}^{-1}$

3.

$$g_{3D}(E_1) = \frac{1}{2\pi^2} \left(\frac{2m^*}{\hbar^2} \right)^{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{E_1} = 5.38 \times 10^{64} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ J}^{-1}$$

If the spin is considered, $g_{3D} = 1.7 \times 10^{26} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ eV}^{-1} = 8.63 \times 10^{25} \text{ m}^{-3} \text{ eV}^{-1}$

$$g_{3D} > g_{2D}$$

$$g_{3D} = \frac{g_{2D}}{2}$$